

Research areas International Relations; conflict studies; political risk and early warning; Sri Lanka and South Asia; Syrian/Kurdish politics; rebel governance; qualitative and mixed-method research.

Academic Positions

- 10/2024–10/2025 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, *University of Naples "L'Orientale"*, Naples (Italy). Project: RAP-RISK (Political Risk Measurement: Risks and Opportunities). Research on early warning systems, crisis recognition failures, and political risk analysis. Case studies: Sri Lanka, Israel, Palestine.
- 10/2019–05/2024 **Doctoral Researcher**, *University of Milan*, Milan (Italy). PhD in Political Science. Research on ethnic conflict, rebel political institutions, and governance in NE Syria, Sri Lanka, and Nepal. Fieldwork in Turkey, KRI-Iraq, and Sri Lanka; training in qualitative and quantitative methods.

Research Affiliations

- 2026– **Associated Member**, *Center on the International Politics of Food Security (CIPFS)*, Interuniversity research centre, University of Pavia (Italy).
- 06/2025–06/2026 **Research Fellow (non-resident)**, *Civil War Paths – Centre for the Comparative Study of Civil Wars*, University of York (UK).

Consulting & Professional Experience

- 07/2025 **Consultant**, *ACAPS*, Switzerland / Remote. Expert review and recommendations on a report on humanitarian risk in Syria.
- 11/2024–03/2025 **Consultant**, *National Peace Council*, Colombo (Sri Lanka). Staff training on research methods.
- 08/2023–05/2025 **Consultant**, *Arci (NGO)*, Italy / Remote. Country of Origin Information research; staff training on asylum procedures and socio-political context.
- 02/2021–07/2022 **Researcher & Consultant**, *Operazione Colomba – Nonviolent Peace Corps*, Italy / Remote. Research on rebel groups and human rights in North-East Syria.

Education

- 2024 **PhD in Political Science**, *University of Milan*, Italy. Dissertation: *Why Fight When You Can Rule Together? Rebel Power-Sharing During Civil Wars*.
- 2014–2017 **MA in Comparative International Relations**, *Ca' Foscari University of Venice*, Italy. Final grade: 110/110 *cum laude*. Visiting Graduate Student, University of Toronto (2016–2017); Erasmus+, Bogazici University (2015–2016).

Grant

- 2025–2026 **ITALIM: Italy and the International Politics of Food Security**, Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MAECI). Principal proposal writer; awarded competitive inter-university research grant.

Selected Publications

- Forthcoming Novellis, Andrea. "A House Divided Against Itself? Ideology, Trust, and the Limits of Kurdish Cooperation in the Syrian Civil War." *Civil Wars*.
- Forthcoming Corradi, Edoardo, and Andrea Novellis. "Earning, Allocating, Providing: The Financial and Budget Management of the Democratic Autonomous Administration of North and East Syria." *Civil Wars*.
- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "The Divided Self: How Ideological Compartmentalization Drives Rebel-to-Party Success in Sri Lanka." *Democratization*.
- 2025 Novellis, Andrea, and Davide Grasso. "Introduction: Exploring the Kurdish Movement." *Partecipazione e Conflitto* 17(3 bis).
- 2018 Novellis, Andrea. "The Rise of Feminism in the PKK." *Zanj: The Journal of Critical Global South Studies*; "An Alternative to Nationalism: The Kurdish Movement in Turkey." *Occhiali. Rivista sul Mediterraneo islamico*.

Books, Reports & Policy Papers

- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Early Warning and Sri Lanka's Economic Crisis." In Ruth Hanau Santini, Andrea Novellis, Rajni Gamage, and Devyani Chaturvedi, eds., *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia*. ISAS Special Report 37.
- 2026 Novellis, Andrea. "Three Critical Fault Lines: Food Security and Stability in Syria's Transition." Policy brief, ITALIM Project, University of Naples "L'Orientale", forthcoming.
- 2025 Novellis, Andrea. "Le Relazioni Esterne del DAANES nell'Interregno Siriano" ["The External Relations of DAANES in the Syrian Interregnum"]. In *La guerra civile siriana*. Rome: Carocci.

Editorial Work & Academic Service

- 2026– Co-editor, Special Issue "Informality and Global Political Orders: Mechanisms of Governance Across States, Conflicts, and Diplomacy", *Cambridge Review of International Affairs*, forthcoming; co-editor, *Humanitarianism, Development Assistance, Early Warning and Political Violence in South Asia*, ISAS Special Report 37, Institute of South Asian Studies, National University of Singapore.
- 2025– Member, Academic Advisory Board, *Vienna Kurdish Studies Yearbook*.
- 2025 Co-editor, Special Issue "Exploring the Kurdish Movement", *Partecipazione e Conflitto*.
- 2023–2026 Co-organizer of academic workshops/conferences at University of Naples "L'Orientale", University of Turin, and University of Salento.

Selected Conference Presentations

- 2026 "The Authoritarian Settlement Playbook: Learning and Conflict Management in Turkey", Kurdish Studies Conference, London School of Economics, London (UK).
- 2025 "Evaluating Early Warning Systems in Policy-Driven Crises", IPSA World Congress, Seoul (South Korea).
- 2025 "The Gaza Crisis and the Limitations of Predictive Systems in Protracted Conflict", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Kent (UK).
- 2025 "The Failure of Israeli Early Warning on October 7: What Lies Behind It?", SISP Conference, Università Federico II, Naples (Italy).
- 2024 "From Rebellion to Realpolitik: The JVP's Role in Post-Conflict Sri Lanka", Conflict Research Society Conference, University of Edinburgh (UK).
- 2024 "A Community Reimagined: The Sri Lanka Muslim Congress and the Shaping of Muslim Identity", Maydan–SeSaMO Conference, Sapienza University of Rome (Italy).
- 2023 "Alliance Formation and Rebel Co-Governance in North-East Syria: The Case of the PYD and the Syriac Union Party", ECPR General Conference, Charles University, Prague (Czechia).

Policy & Public Writing

- 2025 "The Paradox of Syria's New Peace." *The Loop* (ECPR).
- 2024 "The JVP and Ethnic Relations: Walking a Tightrope to 2024" (Parts 1–3). *Groundviews*.

Languages

- Italian Native speaker.
- English C2 CEFR.